PERFORMANCE MARKETING · PAID MEDIA

Paid media audit and strategy proposal: from cheap leads to ICP leads

Meta, Google Search and ChatGPT Ads · what we ran in 2026, what the data says, and the structure I propose for Q4 2026 and 2027.

Felipe Cárdenas · Performance Marketing & CRM · 14 October 2026
Data: platform exports 1 Jan – 12 Oct 2026 (USD; EUR at 1.1177), HubSpot ICP audit (Oct 2025 – Sep 2026, aggregates only), the agency's weekly reports, EMEA H1 deck.
Strategy source: *B2B Lead Gen Paid Media Playbook 2026: Meta, Google Search & ChatGPT Ads*.

SUMMARY

In one page

Where we are

$282.5k spent to 12 Oct (94% of the $300k budget): Meta $180.8k, Google $101.5k, ChatGPT $0.3k. Current pace $1.9k/week.

8,878 platform leads: 7,387 Meta registrations at $24.5 and 1,491 Google conversions at $68.1.

Meta's best month for cost was January ($11); Google's best is now (Sep–Oct, ≈$30–41) after the August rebuild.

EMEA H1: 954 MQLs, 43 SQLs, $2.1k per SQL, 66 days MQL → SQL.

What the data says is wrong

We optimise to form fills, so we get startups and "Other". Paid social: 61% of all content downloads, 0.2% qualified by sales; 40% of paid-social Contact-us leads are disqualified (organic search: 9%).

ICP can't be measured: job title empty for 67% of Contact-us and 83% of download contacts.

Structure is pre-Andromeda: 7 Meta prospecting campaigns split by geography, each too small to learn; Google ran 14 country, region and US-state Search campaigns in H1 (NY $614, FL $400 per conversion).

Tracking broke twice (welcome event dark 15 Jul – 11 Aug; HubSpot vs platform gaps of 7×); lead definition changed 5 times.

$12.1k on YouTube / Demand Gen for 3 conversions.

What I propose

One qualified signal: define an "ICP lead" in HubSpot (corporate 10,000+ or government, target role), fire the platform conversion only for those, and send it back to Meta and Google.

Meta: 7 → 3 campaigns (EMEA, Americas, warm), broad Advantage+ audiences, 8–12 genuinely different creatives per region that say who the ad is for.

Google: keep the two non-brand Search engines, rebuild ad groups by intent with exact/phrase, add brand and competitor, qualifier headlines, AI Max and PMax only after offline conversions flow.

Stop paying for views: pause YouTube video-view campaigns inside the lead-gen budget.

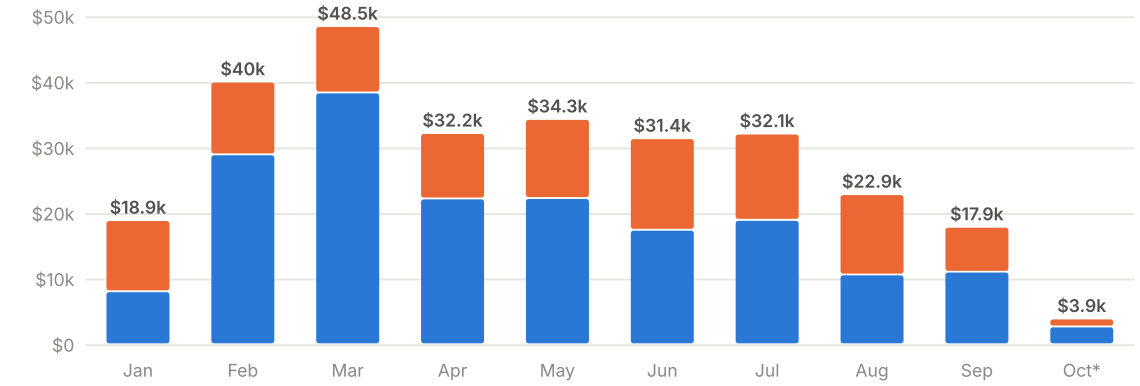
ChatGPT Ads: 60-day test in Q1 2027 once CRM-verified tracking exists; LinkedIn stays off (manager's call).

Target: report and bid on **cost per qualified (ICP) lead** and cost per SQL instead of CPL. Proposed KPI wording for the −20% Meta CPL goal: −20% cost per *qualified* lead, because filtering raises raw CPL on purpose.

What we spent and what the platforms call leads

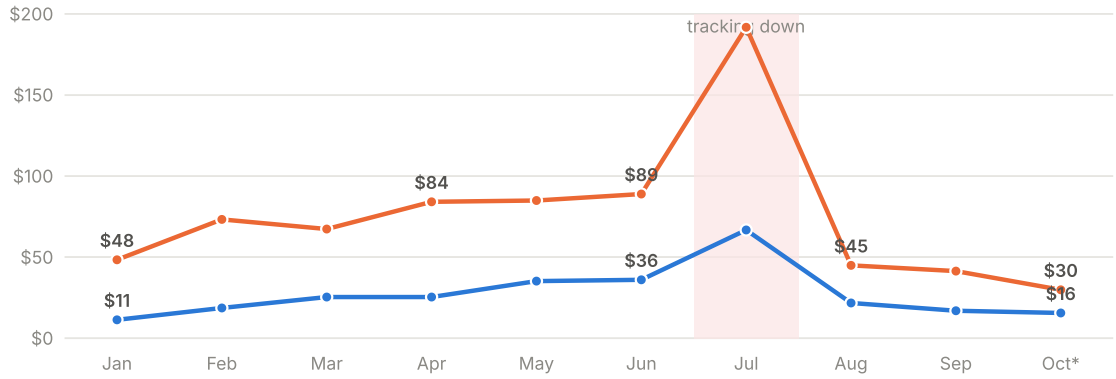
SPENT TO 12 OCT	META	GOOGLE ADS	LAST FULL WEEK	LEFT TO YEAR END	EMEA H1 (TEREZA)
$282,524	**$180,767**	**$101,500**	**$1,887**	**$17,476**	**43 SQLs**
94% of $300k · 78% of the year	7,387 registrations · $24.5 each	1,491 conversions · $68.1 each	Meta $11.6 / reg · Google $26.4 / conv	≈ $1,529 a week · $37.5k to the $320k max	954 MQLs · $2.1k per SQL · 66 days MQL→SQL

Spend by month and channel



Meta Google Ads * October = 1–12 Oct

Cost per platform lead by month



Meta: cost per website registration Google: cost per conversion (the agency's definition changed during the year)

Meta reads cheap: $11–25 per registration most months, $11.6 last week after the September cuts.

"Lead" is the platform's word, not sales'. Meta counts a "welcome" page view after a form; Google's conversion action was redefined four times. Neither is an MQL or an SQL. The next slides look at who those leads are.

Sources: Meta Ads Manager and Google Ads exports, campaign × day; spend tracker. Google converted from EUR at 1.1177.

AUDIT · STRUCTURE

How the accounts are built today, against the 2026 structure

Meta – 9 campaigns live, 18 this year

Campaign	Spend	Regs	CPL	Status
Geo:EMEA prospecting (CBO, 12 Jul)	$3.3k	295	$11.2	Live
Geo:WW retargeting (CBO)	$12.0k	507	$23.6	Live
Geo:US-California prospecting	$6.6k	222	$29.6	Live
Geo:US-East-Coast prospecting	$5.5k	250	$21.9	Live
Geo:USCA prospecting (17 Jun)	$4.2k	143	$29.0	Live
Geo:US-Middle-South prospecting	$3.2k	124	$26.1	Live
Geo:Middle-East prospecting	$2.6k	89	$29.0	Live
Geo:Western-Europe prospecting	$2.6k	120	$21.4	Live
Geo:USCA traffic (cold)	$0.7k	3	$246	Live
Ended: EMEA ABO (Feb–Jul), EMEA test CBO, US-EastCoast, California test, EMEA retargeting, Geo:All welcome, CFA Amazon	$135.7k	5,626	$24	Ended

All prospecting campaigns use the Leads objective and send people to website forms (no Instant Forms). Result = "website registration completed" (a custom conversion on the welcome page).

Google – 5 campaigns live, 37 this year

Campaign	Cost	Conv.	Per conv.	Status
Geo:NA non-brand Search (13 Aug)	€5.2k	119	€44	Live
Geo:EMEA non-brand Search (13 Aug)	€4.3k	106	€41	Live
Geo:US-SV coworking Search	€1.1k	45	€25	Live
PNP_EMEA + PNP_US YouTube video views	€5.9k	1	€4.2k	Live
Geo:NA PMax (8 Jun – 10 Sep)	€3.1k	288	€11	Paused
9 country / region Search campaigns Jan–Aug (EMEA, US, US-CA, UK, FR, IT, SA, US-South, US-East)	€50.5k	688	€73	Ended
5 US state Search (NY, FL, TX, NJ, AZ), Jan–May	€13.1k	42	€312	Ended
PMax Quiz EMEA + US (Jan–Apr)	€1.7k	168	€10	Ended
YouTube / Demand Gen reach (12 campaigns)	€4.9k	2	–	Ended

Non-brand Search is 81% of Google spend. No brand campaign since 14 Jan. Conversion goal switched to "HubSpot qualified leads only" on 14 Sep (15 leads at $190.69 that week).

Why this structure under-delivers. Meta needs ~50 optimisation events per ad set per week to leave the learning phase; our regional campaigns get 10–40. Splitting California out of USCA in January "hurt Meta" (agency, 19 Jan); the June split into US region CBOs was followed by a 70% CPL rise. On Google, 14 geo Search campaigns ran in H1: €312 per conversion in the 5 US states, €73 in the 9 country and region campaigns; the two consolidated campaigns since August cost €41–44.

What the playbook recommends instead. Meta: 3 campaigns maximum (prospecting, optional testing, warm), 1–2 broad ad sets, 8–15 distinct creatives each; separate ad sets by market only where cost per lead differs a lot. Google: 4–5 intent-based campaigns (brand, high intent, competitor, discovery, remarketing), exact/phrase first, broad and AI Max only once offline conversions flow.

Spend and leads 1 Jan – 12 Oct 2026 as reported by each platform. Google in EUR as billed.

Meta: cheap registrations, mostly not the people we sell to

Market / campaign group	Spend	Regs	CPL	CTR	What it tells us
EMEA – multi-country (4 campaigns)	$96.2k	4,238	$22.7	1.27%	The engine. The Feb ABO campaign did 2,238 regs at $32; the Jul CBO does them at $11 with 2.3% CTR.
US & Canada (USCA, 3 campaigns)	$16.6k	846	$19.6	1.54%	Cheapest US market; split into 4 regional CBOs in June, each now too small to learn.
California (2)	$18.1k	695	$26.1	0.99%	Lowest CTR; CPC $3.40 vs $1.24 in EMEA.
US East Coast (2)	$21.2k	600	$35.3	1.25%	Most expensive region; Apr–Jun campaign at $45.
Worldwide (retargeting + Jan 'welcome' campaign)	$13.5k	667	$20.3	0.98%	Retargeting spend tripled Jul–Sep (to $3k/month). Offer is the same content; should carry the demo / JTP ask.
US South & Central, Middle East, W. Europe (Jun–Jul)	$8.4k	333	$25.2	1.3–2.5%	Middle East: 2.5% CTR, $0.36 CPC, $29 CPL.
FR_Alibaba (traffic, internal team) + USCA traffic	$5.2k	11	$475	1.5%	Traffic objective: 130k link clicks, 11 registrations. Not lead gen.

Regs = "website registrations completed". Meta average 2026: $24.5, 1.38% CTR, $0.72 CPC (incl. traffic campaigns). Attribution changed in March 2026 (click-through only), so Jan–Feb CPLs are not like-for-like.

Working

- EMEA prospecting, July CBO: $11 per registration, 2.3% CTR, 144 regs in September.
- Report-led creative: "Quantum Leap" (4,627 download contacts, 19% corporate) and "Spain's Grid Resilience" (1,585, 21% corporate) were the agency's top ads.
- Post-cut efficiency: $1,174 → 101 regs last week ($11.6).

Not working

- Quality: of the leads Meta sends to HubSpot, 0.2% (downloads) and 1.4% (Contact us) get qualified by sales; 40% of Contact-us leads are disqualified.
- 7 prospecting campaigns for ≈$160/day in total: no ad set reaches 50 events a week.
- Ads not aimed at a persona: nothing in the names or offers filters startups out; the "AICOI" ad took a large share of spend at high CPL (May).
- Traffic objective campaigns ($5.2k, 11 regs).

Sources: Meta export; HubSpot ICP audit (paid social original source); agency weekly notes.

Google: Search works when consolidated, everything else was reach

Campaign group	Spend	Conv.	Per conv.	CTR	What it tells us
Non-brand Search, consolidated NA + EMEA (since 13 Aug)	$10.7k	225	$47	9.7%	Best Search result of the year: €41–44 per conversion, $30 in October. Budget-limited since the 19 Sep cuts (€63/day).
Non-brand Search by country, Jan–Aug (EMEA, US, FR, UK, IT, SA)	$34.1k	548	$62	9.6%	EMEA $54, FR $59, IT $34, SA $38 — fine. UK $117 and US $74. Google-side CPL rose Apr–Jul as keywords were broadened, then cut.
Non-brand Search, US regions and states (CA, East, South, NY, FL, TX, NJ, AZ)	$37.0k	183	$202	1–7%	CPCs of $10–21 in the states and 1 conversion every 2–3 weeks. 36% of Google spend for 12% of conversions.
Performance Max (NA Jun–Sep; Quiz EMEA/US Jan–Apr)	$5.5k	460	$12	3.0%	Cheapest conversions on the account, which is exactly why the playbook warns about PMax on form fills: no sign they were ICP.
YouTube video views + Demand Gen (14 campaigns)	$12.1k	3	$4.0k	0.1–8%	Branding paid from the lead-gen budget; the agency flagged it on 17 Aug. Two video-view campaigns still run at €10/day each.
Brand Search (to 14 Jan) · Coworking Search (US-SV)	$0.9k · $1.2k	28 · 45	$34 · $28	15% · 8%	Brand has been off since 14 Jan. Coworking is a startup product: keep it out of the corporate lead-gen figures.

USD at 1.1177. "Conversions" = the account's primary conversion actions: JTP form → welcome page → proxy event (Jul–Aug outage) → HubSpot qualified leads only (from ~15 Sep). Google's own search-term data was not in the exports; 51% of Google spend had no country label in the agency's reporting tool (24 Aug).

Working

- Two consolidated non-brand Search campaigns: 225 conversions at $47 in 9 weeks, 10% CTR.
- Italy ($34), Middle East ($38), France ($59) when run as country campaigns: local terms convert.
- Switching the goal to HubSpot-qualified leads (14 Sep) is the right direction, even if volume dropped.

Not working

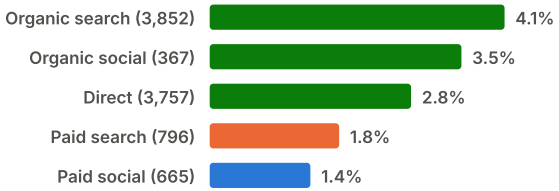
- US region and state campaigns: $37.0k for 183 conversions.
- Lead quality: paid search Contact-us leads 1.8% qualified, 23% disqualified; 2.6% from corporates with 10,000+ employees.
- Video for views: $12.1k, 3 conversions.
- No brand campaign, no competitor campaign, no negatives shared with sales' disqualification reasons.

Sources: Google Ads export; agency logs (budgets, goal changes); HubSpot ICP audit (paid search original source).

AUDIT · LEAD QUALITY

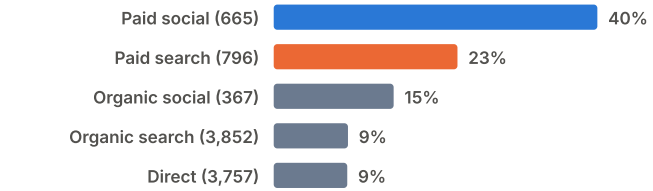
Who the paid leads are: volume from paid social, quality from search

Contact-us leads qualified by sales, by source



Share of contacts with Lead Status qualified / converted / SQL (Salesforce). Oct 2025 – Sep 2026.

… and disqualified by sales



Paid social sends the most leads sales throws away: 4× the organic rate.

Content downloads: paid social is the firehose

FROM PAID SOCIAL
8,214
61% of all download contacts

QUALIFIED BY SALES
0.2%
<5 with a deal · 0 customers

CORPORATE 10,000+
5.5%
449 contacts · 355 strict ICP incl. government

PROFILE "OTHER / JOB SEEKER / STUDENT"
42%
of all download contacts

The root cause is the signal, not the channels. Both platforms are told that a form fill is the win, so they find the people most likely to fill forms: startups (79% of Contact-us contacts) and students. Corporates with 10,000+ employees are 2% of Contact-us contacts and 6% of downloaders, yet they are the ones who qualify (18%) and get deals (5%). Strict ICP corporates: 24 Contact-us contacts, 46% qualified.

What this means for the plan. Every structural and creative change on the next slides is in service of one switch: optimise to an ICP-qualified lead instead of a form fill. Before that signal exists, the cheapest fix is a qualifying form plus a thank-you page that only ICP-fit leads reach (the platform conversion fires there). The second fix is making job title and company size mandatory, so quality can be measured at all.

Source: HubSpot read-only audit (PNP_ICP_vs_Conversions), unique contacts, counts under 5 shown as <5. Lifecycle stage not used (95% are 'SQL' in HubSpot).

CONTEXT · META

Andromeda: creative is the targeting now, and our account was built for the old system

Andromeda is the retrieval stage of Meta's ad system: the step that narrows tens of millions of eligible ads to a few thousand candidates per person, before ranking and the auction. Meta described it on 2 Dec 2024 (10,000× more model complexity, +8% ad quality on tested segments); it was fully global by October 2025, with the GEM ranking model on top (Nov 2025) and Meta's first generative retrieval model in July 2026 (+15.7% conversions in Q2, per Meta).

	Before (to 2024)	After Andromeda (2025–26)
Who sees the ad	Interests, lookalikes and exclusions filtered the audience first	The system reads the creative and pairs it with the likeliest person; targeting inputs are suggestions
Structure	Many ad sets, one per audience or geography	One campaign per objective, 1–3 broad ad sets
Ads per ad set	Meta said max 6	Guidance removed; 8–15 genuinely different concepts
What counts as different	Any variation	Same look or same opening hook = the same ad (creative diversity label since Aug 2026)
Creative fatigue	6+ weeks	2–3 weeks; weekly refresh
Your job	Targeting and bidding	Creative, offer and the conversion signal you send back

Meta's own test: one ad set with 25 diverse creatives beat five ad sets × five creatives by 17% more conversions at 16% lower cost. Source: playbook (Segwise, Ad Advisor, Atria, Chatterbuzz, Relevant Audience, Jon Loomer).

Why it matters for Plug and Play

Our Meta account is built the old way: 7 prospecting campaigns by geography, few ads each, each ad set far below the 50 events/week needed to learn. That is the pattern Andromeda punishes.

Our ads don't say who they are for. Since the creative now does the targeting, "for innovation leaders at 10,000+ employee companies" has to be in the first line and the visual; otherwise the system keeps finding startups.

Reports as the only creative concept means Meta treats our ads as near-identical and rotates between the same people.

Other 2026 Meta changes we have to price in

March 2026 attribution: click-through conversions only count after a link click; CPL baselines before March are not comparable.

Location fees since 1 Jul: +3% Spain, France and Italy, +2% UK, on top of budget.

Q4 CPM pressure: Meta's price per ad +12% year on year in Q2.

New controls: Sequenced Events (lead → booked call) and "qualified leads" optimisation for website leads (6 Oct); placement exclusions moving to account level; automatic pixel events and an AI assistant that can change budgets — keep approvals human.

All platform facts from the playbook's dated sources; our account facts from the Meta export and agency notes.

CONTEXT · GOOGLE SEARCH

Search in 2026: intent capture, with the AI switches off until the CRM talks back

What changed on Google Search in 2026

Change	What to do at PnP
AI Max is switched on for you (1 Sep): campaigns with auto-created assets or campaign-level broad match were upgraded automatically; DSA migrates Feb 2027	Audit both Search campaigns now; keep AI Max off until offline conversions flow (the agency planned to launch it on 31 Aug)
Exact and phrase match now serve in AI Mode for direct-intent queries (9 Sep)	We don't need AI Max to appear in AI answers for high-intent corporate-innovation terms
Enhanced Conversions for Leads + Data Manager (offline import moved 15 Jun); uploads after 7 days are ignored by attribution	HubSpot → Google daily: MQL, SQL, opportunity, won. Store GCLID on the contact
Smart Bidding needs ~30 conversions/month per campaign; value-based bidding fails on low volume	Max conversions → tCPA on qualified leads once each campaign has 30+/month; no value bidding yet
PMax for B2B works only with ~50 qualified conversions/month and offline data	Keep PMax paused; re-test with the qualified goal, never on form fills (our PMax got $12 'conversions')
Business Agent for Leads, lead intent scores (US beta)	Watch; publish ICP-fit, process and FAQ pages so the agent has material when it reaches the EU
Ad language follows the search term (Sep)	Separate FR / IT / DE / ES ad groups and RSAs; local content beat generic 3:1 on CPL at PnP

Search in the playbook's structure

Campaign	Match	Bidding	Share
1. Brand	Exact (+phrase); 'login', 'jobs' negative	Max conv. / tCPA	10–15%
2. Non-brand high intent (corporate innovation platform, open innovation programme, startup scouting partner, innovation lab…)	Phrase + exact	Max conv. → tCPA on qualified lead	40–50%
3. Competitor (alternatives, vs, pricing)	Exact + phrase	tCPA, CPC caps	10–20%
4. Problem / discovery ('how to run a corporate venture programme')	Broad or AI Max only with offline conversions	Value-based later	15–20%
5. Remarketing / Demand Gen	Site visitors, Customer Match	Max conv.	5–10%

RSA rules that filter leads for free: 10–15 headlines, 2 qualifier headlines ("For corporates with 10,000+ employees", "Innovation programmes for enterprises"), 2 proof headlines (named corporate partners), offer as headline, partial pinning. Negatives from sales' disqualification reasons every week: jobs, students, startup funding, accelerator applications (startups have their own JTP path).

Google's own number: broad match + Smart Bidding ≈ +20% conversions, but B2B specialists see 50–70% of broad spend on non-converting searches without offline data.

Source: playbook (Google Ads Help, Common Thread, GrowthSpree, Directive, Lunio, TripleDart); PnP facts from the Google export and agency logs.

CONTEXT · CHATGPT ADS

ChatGPT Ads: worth one disciplined test, not a lead engine yet

Our 10-day test (23 Sep – 2 Oct)

SPEND	IMPRESSIONS	CLICKS	CONVERSIONS
€229.56	4,021	43	0
$257		1.07% CTR · €5.34 CPC	as reported by OpenAI

This matches the public B2B tests in the playbook: cheap-ish clicks, real reach, no qualified leads yet (Windmill: $1,470, 0 conversions; Workshop Digital: $2,319, 0 MQLs; another test: 336 clicks → 146 companies, 5 in ICP). One founder saw OpenAI count 57 clicks where GA4 showed under 20 visits.

Platform facts that limit us

- Only **Free and Go** users see ads; Plus, Pro, Business and Enterprise users (a good part of our ICP) are unreachable.
- **No personalised ads in the EEA** at launch: matching is on the conversation plus language and rough location; custom audiences unusable for European campaigns.
- No keywords, match types, search-term report or schedules: targeting is written as **context hints** (buyer situations).

How to run the next test (Q1 2027, 60 days)

1. **Gate:** OpenAI Pixel + Conversions API live, with the event fired only after HubSpot accepts the lead (ICP-fit), and GA4 reconciliation from day one.
2. **Budget:** €1,500–2,000 a month, 5–8% of paid media; decide the ceiling first (e.g. cost per qualified lead must stay within 1.5× Google Search).
3. **Structure:** 2 campaigns (EMEA-EN, US-EN; Spanish later), 3–5 ad groups each by buyer problem: "setting up a corporate innovation programme", "finding startups for a pilot", "benchmarking our innovation function", "open innovation partner evaluation".
4. **Context hints** as buyer situations, 5–10 per group: "Head of Innovation at a 10,000+ employee manufacturer comparing ways to source and pilot startups" — not a keyword list.
5. **Offer:** research-stage, not a demo: the Company Performance Report, the Enterprise AI playbook, an innovation maturity assessment. 3–6 literal, benefit-led ads per group.
6. **Verdict after 60 days** on cost per qualified lead vs Search; otherwise keep as a €300/month awareness line and retest when Sponsored Agents and conversion bidding mature.

Also in the plan: HubSpot's native ChatGPT Ads integration (16 Sep) if available on our account; automatic copy localisation for ES/FR/IT.

Sources: OpenAI Ads export (campaigns_1.csv); playbook (OpenAI Help, Windmill Strategy, Workshop Digital, BCC Interactive, Factors.ai).

AUDIT · CREATIVES

Creatives: one concept, no persona, slow refresh

What I can see from the data

One concept: the report cover. The two top Meta ads were research downloads (Quantum Leap, Spain's Grid Resilience). Good as cold offers, but 81% of their downloaders are not corporate, and the ads give Meta no persona to aim at.

No qualifier in the creative. Nothing says "for corporates" or "for innovation leaders"; startups self-select in.

Two-month creative cycles. Agency notes mention new ads in Jul and "case-study statics" on 8 Oct; Andromeda-era fatigue is 2–3 weeks.

Formats we never ran: talking-head video (in the 60-day plan), customer story, comparison, native-post style, partnership ads.

What I could not audit from here: the ads themselves (the agency's Creative Reports were not shared; I have no Ads Manager preview access yet). First task with Thiago before 30 Oct: export the ad-level report with creative names, spend and registrations, and the Meta Ad Library links.

The creative system to build (per region, 8–12 concepts live)

Concept	Persona called out	Format	Offer / CTA
"Your innovation programme runs on pilots. Here is how 20+ corporates source them."	Head of Innovation, 10,000+ employees	Founder / regional MD talking head, 45–60 s, captions	Corporate innovation guide
Named corporate case (Mitsubishi Electric × Kamet AI, SMBC...)	R&D / CDO	Customer story static + 15 s cut	Case study pack
Before / after: 'scouting in spreadsheets vs a vetted startup pipeline'	Innovation manager	Comparison static	Book a 20-min scouting call
Number-led: '2025 Company Performance Report: X pilots, Y countries'	C-level	Report cover + 3 takeaways	Download (gated, ICP form)
Government / public sector: 'How ministries run innovation programmes with us'	Government innovation lead	Native post style	Programme brief
Local-language versions for FR, IT, DE, ES (local beat generic 3:1 at PnP)	Same personas, local MD on camera	Talking head + static	Local report

Rules: change at least two of persona / angle / format / hook between concepts; one problem, one promise, one CTA; 9:16 and 4:5 of each; headline = the offer; check Meta's creative diversity label (no ad set at Low); replace the bottom 2–3 ads every two weeks; build new concepts as 3-2-2 flexible ads in their own ad set inside the main CBO. Label any AI-generated photoreal asset (EU AI Act, 2 Dec).

Sources: agency weekly notes (top ads, launches); HubSpot ICP audit (downloaders by asset); playbook creative section.

Tracking: the conversion fires for everyone, so the platforms learn nothing

The funnel as it works today, and where it leaks

Ad
Report or JTP ad, no persona call-out; Meta and Google both optimise to the welcome page.

→

Landing page / form
Same page for startups and corporates; job title empty on 67–83% of contacts; welcome-page templates broke in Jul–Aug and took tracking down for 4 weeks.

→

Thank-you / welcome page
Fires the platform conversion for **everyone** who submits: startup founder, student, job seeker, corporate CDO alike.

→

HubSpot
95% of contacts are "SQL" by lifecycle stage, so HubSpot stages can't be used as a signal; Persona and Decision-maker-fit fields empty; HubSpot vs platform lead counts differ by up to 7×.

→

Salesforce
Lead Status is the only usable quality field (qualified / disqualified); MQL → SQL takes 66 days.

→

Back to the platforms
Nothing. No CAPI for CRM, no offline conversion import. The platforms never learn which leads were good.

Landing page and form rules (from the playbook)

- **Two paths**: a corporate page (ICP wording, named partners, 2-step form: work email + company, then role and company size, then a calendar) and the existing startup JTP path. Separate forms, separate events.
- **Required fields that filter**: job title as a dropdown of roles; company size bands; work email only. Turn off autofill on those fields if we use Instant Forms later.
- **Message match**: H1 repeats the ad's promise; proof (logos, one result number) next to the form; form above the fold on a 390 px screen; one page per Google ad-group theme.
- **Tracking in the page**: capture gclid, fbclid, UTMs and an event ID in hidden fields; fire the lead event from Pixel + Conversions API with the same event ID; consent mode v2.

The qualified thank-you page: the fastest quality fix

After the form, route by answers: ICP-fit (corporate 10,000+ or government, target role) → **/thank-you-qualified**, where the Meta Lead and Google conversion fire. Everyone else → a resources page with **no** event.

Both platforms then optimise to ICP leads within days, without waiting for the CRM integration. This is the move Ben Heath paid $235k for in Hormozi's playbook, and it costs us a form rule and one page.

Next step (weeks, not days): HubSpot → Meta Conversions API for CRM (free via Make until Feb 2028) and HubSpot → Google Enhanced Conversions for Leads, sending MQL / SQL / opportunity / won with the click IDs. Meta's 6 Oct "qualified leads" goal and Sequenced Events (lead → booked call) then work for website leads too.

I have not been able to load the live pages from this environment; this is the checklist I will run page by page with Aly and Rosa (landing pages) next week.

Sources: HubSpot ICP audit; agency notes (3 Aug: 'client web team to fix welcome landing-page templates'; 27 Apr: HubSpot 143 vs 20 tracked); playbook.

The structure I propose: fewer, bigger learning units, aimed at the ICP

Meta · 3 campaigns (now 9)

Campaign	Setup
1. Prospecting EMEA (50% of Meta)	Leads objective, CBO, 1 broad Advantage+ ad set with ICP suggestions (job-title interests, customer list as signal); countries: UK, FR, DE, ES, IT + rest of EMEA; Middle East as a 2nd ad set only if CPL differs a lot. 8–12 concepts; local-language ad set for FR/IT/DE/ES.
2. Prospecting Americas (30%)	Same build, US + Canada in one ad set (state splits ended); control ad set of proven winners + one ad set per new concept (3-2-2 ads).
3. Warm (15–25%)	Site visitors 30–180 d, video viewers 50%+, downloaders who are ICP (CRM list), form openers; offer = named case studies and a 20-min call, not another report. Exclude customers, open opportunities, employees.
Conversion	Website, event = qualified thank-you page now; Meta 'qualified leads' / Conversion Leads via CAPI for CRM once stages flow. Cost cap once CPL is stable.

Google · 5 campaigns (now 5, different ones)

Campaign	Setup
1. Brand (10%)	Exact; negatives: jobs, login, careers. Relaunch (off since 14 Jan).
2. Non-brand EMEA (35%)	Keep the Aug campaign; rebuild ad groups by intent (corporate innovation programme, open innovation, startup scouting, innovation lab/CoE, government innovation); phrase + exact; FR/IT/DE/ES ad groups with local RSAs and pages.
3. Non-brand Americas (30%)	Same intents, US + Canada; no state campaigns.
4. Competitor (10%, test)	2–3 corporate-innovation competitors, honest comparison pages, CPC caps.
5. Discovery (later)	Broad / AI Max as a 50/50 experiment only after SQL import runs; PMax re-test with the qualified goal at 30–50 qualified/month.
Everything	Presence targeting, Search only, auto-apply off, 60–90 day window, universal negatives EN + local, observation audiences, 15-headline RSAs with qualifier lines, sitelinks to case studies / programmes / contact.

ChatGPT Ads · 1 test

Item	Setup
Timing	Q1 2027, 60 days, after the CRM-verified event exists
Size	€1.5–2k / month
Structure	2 campaigns × 3–5 problem ad groups, research-stage offers
Keep if	cost per qualified lead ≤ 1.5× Google Search

Not in scope

LinkedIn: off for now (too expensive for the leads we get on Search and Meta; manager's decision). Revisit for company-list targeting in 2027 with a small test.

YouTube / Demand Gen for views: out of the lead-gen budget. If brand reach is wanted, fund it separately and measure with the Branded Search conversion type.

Coworking (US-SV): a startup product; keep, but report it outside the corporate lead-gen numbers.

Budget split to start 2027 (playbook template for a €10–25k/month budget, adapted to our history): Google Search 45–50% · Meta 40% · ChatGPT test 5–10% · reserve 5% for Demand Gen / PMax once offline data qualifies. Rebalance 10–20% a month toward the lowest cost per *qualified* lead, never below 20% on Meta (it creates the demand Search captures). Q4 2026: hold ≈ $1.5–1.9k/week, Meta 60% / Google 40%, with the YouTube €20/day moved into Search.

Shares are of each platform's budget. The structure follows the playbook's recommended B2B builds and keeps PnP's EMEA / Americas split.

What to optimise, update, pause and test

Channel	Campaign	Evidence (2026)	Decision	What changes
Meta	Geo:EMEA prospecting CBO (Jul)	$11 CPL, 2.3% CTR, 144 regs in Sep	Keep + optimise	Becomes Prospecting EMEA: add 8–12 concepts, ICP suggestions, qualified thank-you event, local ad sets.
Meta	Geo:WW retargeting	$23.6 CPL, spend tripled Jul–Sep	Update	Becomes Warm: swap report offers for case studies + call; add CRM ICP lists; cap at 20% of Meta.
Meta	US-California, US-East-Coast, US-Middle-South, USCA prospecting	$22–30 CPL each, 10–40 regs/week each	Update	Merge into one Prospecting Americas CBO (keep the best ads); one ad set, state-level value rules if CRM shows differences.
Meta	Middle-East, Western-Europe prospecting	$29 / $21 CPL, small	Update	Fold into Prospecting EMEA as ad sets (Middle East keeps its own creative).
Meta	Geo:USCA traffic (cold)	$737, 3 registrations	Pause	Traffic objective buys clicks, not leads.
Meta	FR_Alibaba	Ended 5 Oct, internal team	Confirm	Confirm whether it belongs in this budget; keep out of the lead-gen reporting.
Google	Geo:NA non-brand Search	€44/conv, budget-limited	Keep + optimise	Rebuild ad groups by intent; add qualifier headlines; raise budget from €30/day once the qualified goal has data.
Google	Geo:EMEA non-brand Search	€41/conv, €30 in Oct	Keep + optimise	Same, plus FR / IT / DE / ES ad groups and pages; tCPA €45 only after 30 qualified/month.
Google	PNP_EMEA + PNP_US YouTube video views	€5.9k, 1 conversion	Pause	€20/day back into Search. Fund brand video separately if wanted.
Google	Geo:NA PMax (paused)	€11/conv, quality unknown	Keep paused	Re-test in 2027 with the qualified goal and CRM audience signals, 30–50 qualified/month gate.
Google	US state and US-region Search (ended)	€227–614 per conversion	Don't revive	US demand is covered by the Americas campaign; regions and states were 36% of spend for 12% of conversions.
Google	Brand Search	Off since 14 Jan	Relaunch	Exact match, small budget, protects branded demand and gives a clean baseline.
Google	Competitor campaign	Never run	Test	2–3 names, comparison pages, 10% of Google.
Google	US-SV coworking Search	€25/conv, 45 conv	Keep (separate)	Startup product; report outside the corporate numbers.
ChatGPT	Test 1	€230, 43 clicks, 0 conversions	Retest Q1	60-day test with CRM-verified events, buyer-situation hints, research offers.

Sequence: pauses and the thank-you page first (no extra budget), then the Meta merge and Google ad-group rebuild in one change window each (not during the first 7 days of a learning phase), then the signal integrations.

Evidence from the platform exports to 12 Oct 2026 and the agency logs.

Measurement: one qualified signal, one weekly rhythm

The signal we send back, and what we measure

Stage	Definition at PnP	Sent to Meta / Google	Use
Lead	Any form submit	Secondary only	Volume check
ICP lead	Corporate 10,000+ employees (or government) and target role, from the form fields; same day	**Yes – primary optimisation event** (thank-you page now, CAPI for CRM / Enhanced Conversions next)	Bidding and the −20% KPI
MQL	HubSpot MQL (scoring to be fixed; 'seems off' since January)	Yes, value 3×	Weekly report
SQL / meeting	Salesforce Lead Status qualified; 66 days today	Yes, value 10× (reporting; too slow to bid on alone)	Cost per SQL, the real KPI
Opportunity / won	SFDC	Yes, with deal value	Pipeline : spend

Why a fast proxy: Meta needs the optimised stage within 28 days and at 1–40% of leads; Google attribution ignores uploads older than 7 days. SQL (66 days) can't be the bidding signal; the same-day ICP lead can.

Cadence and KPIs

When	What
Daily (10 min)	Spend pacing, broken tracking, disapproved ads, CPL spikes; search terms during any AI Max / broad test
Monday (the tracker + this)	Spend vs budget; leads, ICP leads, cost per ICP lead by campaign; pause losers; launch the week's creative batch; negatives from sales' disqualification reasons
Every 2 weeks	Lead-quality review with sales: 20 random leads per platform scored; MQL fit score check
Monthly	Budget rebalance on cost per SQL and pipeline; concept review (which personas and angles win); leadership summary
Quarterly	Offer refresh, ChatGPT retest, incrementality once spend passes ≈€10k/month per platform

KPIs for the end of 2026 / 2027: cost per ICP lead (new, replaces CPL), ICP leads per week by channel, cost per SQL vs the $2.1k H1 baseline, MQLs from paid search +15% counted as corporate MQLs, Meta −20% on cost per *qualified* lead.

Reporting stays in the weekly tracker plus one HubSpot view by original source and campaign UTM (read-only). All contact-level work stays aggregated (GDPR).

Source: playbook (Meta Conversions API for CRM docs, Google Ads Help, Prose Media); PnP numbers from the H1 deck and HubSpot audit.

PROPOSAL · 90-DAY PLAN

The next 90 days, with gates

Days 1–30 Foundations · Oct 15 – Nov 15

- Thiago handover: ad-level creative report, Ad Library links, location strategy, logs, Ads Manager access.
- Pause USCA traffic and the two YouTube view campaigns; move €20/day to Search.
- Define the ICP lead with Raúl and sales; make job title (dropdown) and company size required on JTP and download forms (with Aly / Rosa).
- Qualified thank-you page live; Meta and Google conversions moved to it; gclid / fbclid / UTM stored in HubSpot.
- Audit both Search campaigns for AI Max auto-upgrade; brief the first 8 Meta concepts (2 talking heads).

Gate: one test lead tracked end to end from ad to Salesforce, and ICP leads counted in HubSpot.

Days 31–60 Rebuild · Nov 16 – Dec 15

- Meta: merge the 4 US campaigns into Prospecting Americas; fold Middle East and Western Europe into EMEA; relaunch Warm with case-study offers. No edits for 7 days after.
- Google: ad groups by intent, 15-headline RSAs with qualifier lines, FR/IT/DE/ES groups, brand relaunch, negatives list EN + local.
- HubSpot → Meta CAPI for CRM (Make) and → Google Enhanced Conversions for Leads: daily uploads of ICP lead, MQL, SQL.
- Weekly creative batches: 3–5 concepts, 2–3 hooks each; retire bottom ads every two weeks.

Gate: 30+ ICP leads per month per platform before any tCPA / qualified-leads bidding switch.

Days 61–90 Optimise and test · Dec 16 – Jan 31

- Switch Meta to "qualified leads" / Conversion Leads and Google to tCPA on the ICP lead where the gate is met.
- Competitor campaign; Advantage+ Leads split test vs the manual build, judged on cost per SQL.
- ChatGPT Ads 60-day test (CRM-verified event).
- 2027 plan: budget by channel on cost per ICP lead; Demand Gen / PMax only if 30–50 qualified a month; LinkedIn retest decision.
- First quarterly review: what worked, what didn't, what's next.

Gate: cost per SQL on target before scaling (+20% every 3–4 days, cost cap on).

Risks

- Raw CPL rises when we filter: say it before it happens; the KPI is cost per ICP lead.
- Fewer campaigns = fewer "lines" in reporting; the By-location view in the tracker still breaks results down by market.
- Q4 CPMs +10–15% and the 3% EU location fees.
- Volume: with ≈$1.5k/week left this year, the rebuild's results show in January, not December.

What I need

- Decision on the ICP-lead definition and on who owns form changes (web team).
- Meta Ads Manager access via Tereza; Salesforce read access for lead status by campaign.
- One hour with sales every two weeks for the lead review.
- Confirmation: FR_Alibaba and ChatGPT in the $300k; 2027 budget envelope; LinkedIn stays off.

Follows the playbook's 90-day roadmap (foundations → launch → optimise → scale) adapted to PnP's live accounts and remaining 2026 budget.

APPENDIX

Sources, definitions and caveats

Data used

Platform exports: Meta Ads Manager ('Plug and Play Tech Center – Dollars', USD) and Google Ads (EUR, converted at 1.1177), campaign × day, 1 Jan – 12 Oct 2026. OpenAI Ads campaign export.

HubSpot ICP audit (read-only, 8 Oct 2026): JTP Contact-us and content-download contacts, 1 Oct 2025 – 30 Sep 2026; outcome = Salesforce Lead Status; aggregates only, counts under 5 shown as <5.

Agency weekly reports (Notion, W/C 29 Dec 2025 – 5 Oct 2026), copied as written: actions, targets, budget logs, lead definitions.

EMEA H1 2026 deck (Tereza): MQLs, SQLs, cost per SQL, MQL → SQL time.

Spend tracker (PNP_Paid_Media_Spend_Tracker_2026): budget status and pace.

Definitions

Meta registration = "website registrations completed" (custom conversion on the welcome page). **Google conversion** = the account's primary conversion action at the time (changed 4 times in 2026).

ICP (Buyer Persona 2024): corporates with 10,000+ employees and $100M+ revenue, Head of Innovation / R&D / CDO / C-level, plus governments; startup founders as the secondary group.

CPL in this deck = platform cost per platform lead. **Cost per ICP lead** and **cost per SQL** are the proposed KPIs.

Strategy sources (via the playbook)

Meta: Meta Engineering (Andromeda, GEM), Meta developer docs (Conversions API for CRM), Jon Loomer, Ben Heath, Professor Charley T, Nick Theriot, Dara Denney, Chatterbuzz, Relevant Audience, SaaS Hero, Flighted, Sotros, Aurelius Media.

Google: Google Ads Help and Ginny Marvin, Common Thread, GrowthSpree, Directive, TripleDart, Lunio B2B panel, Optmyzr (via Webtonic), Surfside PPC, Jyll Saskin Gales (Inside Google Ads).

ChatGPT Ads: OpenAI Help Center and announcements, Windmill Strategy, Workshop Digital, BCC Interactive, Factors.ai, Motainment, Just Global.

Regulation: EU AI Act Article 50 (Usercentrics, Ropes & Gray, s360).

Caveats. Ad-level creatives, search terms, audiences and the live landing pages were not available to me for this audit; the creative and landing-page sections are based on the agency's notes, the HubSpot data and the playbook's rules, and will be completed in the handover with Thiago and with Aly / Rosa. Platform CPLs before March 2026 are not comparable with later months (Meta attribution change). The 2027 budget is not set; splits are percentages.